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The Roswell debris:
“not made on this earth”

— Maj. Jesse Marcel

INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER

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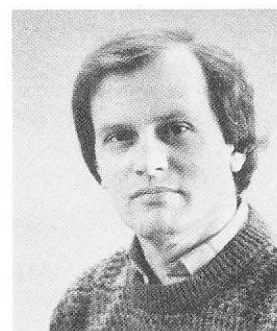
An extraordinary decade

When the history of ufology is written, the decade that has just passed is likely to be remembered as the most important 10-year period in the four decades of the UFO controversy. The stage has been set for what will probably be an even more remarkable next few years.

I have just finished writing a book on ufology in the 1980s. I knew before I started, of course, that the decade had been an unusually interesting one, but it was not until I plunged into the research that I began to comprehend just what had happened. The explosive developments of recent years are all the more remarkable because they occurred in the absence of any major sighting waves, although the relative handful of reports included some of history's most significant UFO events: the Cash-Landrum CE2 (December 1980); the Trans-en-Provence, France, CE2 (January 1981) — the most impressively-documented, evidential landing-trace case of them all; the Westchester, New York, boomerang flap (beginning in 1983); the Japanese Airlines radar/visual sighting (November 1986); the Gulf Breeze, Florida, sightings and photographs (November 1987-May 1988); the Mundrabilla, Australia, CE2 (January 1988). There were also the complex and confusing events at Rendlesham forest in England in December 1980, although we still have no idea of what did or did not occur there; *something* did, surely, and if it was not a UFO encounter, it was something else the authorities sought desperately — and, alas, largely successfully — to cover up. The fall of 1989 saw bizarre and dubious reports coming out of the Soviet Union, from where we are likely to hear a great deal more (and presumably more reliably), now that glasnost has freed Soviet ufology.

Interesting (and evidential) as these reports often were, the most noteworthy developments related to the radical new understanding ufologists — here I refer primarily, though not exclusively, to American ufologists — reached about events that had happened long ago or were happening, unknown to ufologists, all around us. Consider what ufologists knew in late 1979 about these two issues, the cover-up and the abduction phenomenon:

(1) *The cover-up*: In the 1950s most ufologists suspected that the U.S. government knew more about UFOs than it was telling and one of the major organizations, NICAP, lobbied for Congressional hearings on the subject. But what were being covered up, sober investigators thought, were gun-camera films, spectacular radar/visual sightings and other such things. Reports of crashed



Jerome Clark

discs were in circulation, but among mainstream ufologists they were not even an issue. In the late 1970s veteran ufologist Len Stringfield had the courage and foresight to raise the question, to much criticism (from me among others). Todd Zechel was investigating a crash along the Texas-Mexico border, said to have taken place in 1950, but not producing any especially compelling evidence for it. Stanton Friedman and William Moore were quietly investigating an incident that was little more than a footnote in UFO history, an apparent case of foolish hysteria generated by the crash of a weather balloon near Corona, New Mexico, but the two researchers had yet to publish anything. Articles in the UFO literature were bemoaning colleagues' interest in such obvious nonsense and "proving" that such things as crashed discs simply could not be. Many serious ufologists doubted that a cover-up of any kind (even of dramatic gun-camera films) existed; more likely, as Allen Hynek among others argued, the Air Force handling of the UFO problem was more foul-up than cover-up.

(2) *The abduction phenomenon*: The UFO community had known of abduction claims since 1965, when a Boston newspaper published the first account of the Hill experience, and in the following years the names Herb Schirmer, Travis Walton, Sandy Larson and Betty Andreasson would become known to anyone following the phenomenon. But no serious formal studies of the patterns in the reports had been conducted and the much-publicized 1977 experiments of Alvin Lawson and William McCall, who claimed they had proven hypnotically-induced imaginary abductions were identical to "real" ones, seemed to hand ammunition to those who contended "abductions" are nothing more than confabulation, a ufological equivalent of hypnotic past-lives fantasies. Because no psychological studies had been conducted and so few mental-health professionals were actively involving themselves in investigation, it was easy for anyone who wanted to do so to wave his hands and concoct any psychological "explanation" that suited his fancy. Lawson even sought to persuade the UFO community that abductees were not encountering aliens

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Roswell, July 9, 1947

by Don Schmitt and Kevin D. Randle

■ ■ Don Schmitt is CUFOS' director of special investigations. Kevin D. Randle, a former Air Force intelligence officer, is a professional writer and author of *The UFO Casebook* (1989). Schmitt and Randle's book on their investigation of the Roswell incident will be published in late 1990.

Almost everyone has seen the headline from the *Roswell Daily Record* of July 8, 1947. In bold type, the paper announced that the Roswell Army Air Field had captured a flying saucer. Few have seen the paper for the next day. Some researchers are aware of its existence, but because it offers a mundane explanation for all the evidence of the crash, they have ignored it.

On the surface, that paper from July 9, 1947, is a devastating document. Mac Brazel says that he found the object on June 14, that his wife, a son and daughter were with him, and that they carried most of it to ranch headquarters. He says that the material was flimsy, basically tinfoil and sticks, and that he thought nothing of it until he heard about flying saucers a couple of weeks later. Then, while in Roswell to sell wool on July 7, 1947, he mentioned to the sheriff "kind of confidential" that he had found something unusual.

According to the article, which describes the material at length, a portion was smoky gray rubber and it was scattered all over an area about 200 yards in diameter. There were no words or writing on it although there were some letters on some of the parts. Considerable scotch tape and some tape with flowers printed upon it had been used in the construction. According to the article, there were no strings or wires but there were some eyelets in the paper to indicate that some sort of attachment may have been used.

The story ends with Brazel's saying that he had found weather observation devices on two other occasions but what he found this time did not resemble those. "I am sure what I found was not any weather observation balloon," he said, "but if I find anything else besides a bomb they are going to have a hard time getting me to say anything about it."

The facts

Our investigation over the past 18 months has shown conclusively that the newspaper account of July 9 is false, the product of coercion to which Mac Brazel was subjected by military investigators. Testimony from other primary witnesses *who were at the site* in the days after the crash contradicts what Brazel told the *Daily Record*. We also have descriptions of the recovered material from several witnesses whose reports differ radically from the July 9 account.

First, we have learned that the alleged date of Brazel's find, June 14, is incorrect. In an interview conducted in early November 1989, Don Schmitt learned that Brazel himself told investigators from the Roswell Army Air Field on July 8 that he found the debris on July 3. Moreover, he knew there could have been no material in the field as early as June 14 because he had visited the site while tending his sheep on or about June 30 and had seen nothing. Brazel's statement to the investigators is confirmed by other sources, including the Proctors, his nearest neighbors.

We have also learned from a variety of sources, including Bill Brazel, Mac's son, and from Jesse Marcel, Jr., whose father investigated the find, that the debris was scattered over an area three-quarters of a mile long and 200 or 300 feet wide, and that there was a gouge in the ground about 500 feet long. Maj. Marcel, in taped interviews, often said that the debris field was quite large. Others whom we have interviewed have said the debris was dense and that there was a large amount of it. On his first trip to the site on July 7, Marcel filled the back of his '42 Buick station wagon and a counter-intelligence agent who accompanied Marcel loaded his jeep carry-all. Marcel said that after a full day of collecting it a great deal of material still remained at the site.

One of the counter-intelligence agents says he and others were dispatched the next morning (July 8) to bring back more of the debris. Bill Brazel said that his father had carted the largest piece, about 10 feet in diameter, from the field to store in a livestock shed. This was certainly more material than would be found in a simple balloon.

Tommy Tyree, who came to work as Mac Brazel's hired hand after this event, told us that Mac had com-

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Associated Press

Roswell Daily Record

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Movies as Usual

GRAND



Claims Army Is Stacking Courts Martial

Indiana Senator
Lays Protest
Before Patterson

Washington, July 8 (AP)—Senator Jenner (R-Ind.) today contended in the European theater is stacking courts martial against defendants in the European theater.

In a letter to Secretary of War Patterson demanding a full investigation of army military trial procedure, Jenner offered that the said was documentary proof that:

1. "Prisoners are not being permitted to employ either civilian or military counsel of their own choice in the preparation and presentation of their defense."
2. "Every effort is being made to prevent attorneys who are connected with the defense from being permitted to practice in courts martial in the European theater."

RAAF Captures Flying Saucer On Ranch in Roswell Region

House Passes Tax Slash by Large Margin

Defeat Amendment
By Demos to Remove
Many from Rolls

Washington, July 8 (AP)—The house passed today the Republic tax bill by a 302 to 111 vote, defeating a two-thirds majority amendment to remove many from the rolls.

It goes to the senate where approval also is forecast.

The vote was 302 to 111, or more than the two-thirds majority needed to override a presidential veto.

The action, which may encourage another presidential veto, came after Speaker Martin (R-Mass.) personally appealed to the house to pass the bill by such a decisive vote as to persuade the president that the people should have their "day in court."

The measure is identical with one vetoed by President Truman in 1945. It would cut the income tax rate from 37 to 33 percent, except that the effective date is changed from July 1, 1947 to Jan. 1, 1948.

Conferees expect to have the revised bill on Mr. Truman's desk before the week ends.

The house passed the bill after the Republicans lost back a proposed reduction of the tax rate from 37 to 33 percent, and removed 4,000,000 persons from the tax rolls completely.

Security Council Paves Way to Talks On Arms Reductions

Lake Success, July 8 (AP)—The United Nations security council today approved an American initiative for arms reduction discussions despite a Russian warning that the plan would bring about a collapse of arms regulation efforts.

The vote was 9 to 0, with Russia and Poland abstaining.

In view of Russia's firm stand against the U. S. plan it had been believed she might invoke the veto power to block it.

Soviet Deputy Foreign Minister Andrei A. Gromyko gave his warning before the United Nations security council in a new effort to revive the Soviet working plan, which already had been rejected at arms talks.

His challenge was taken up promptly by French delegate Andre Parodi and U. S. Representative H. V. Johnson, who announced their opposition to the plan.

Gromyko insisted that no progress for arms regulation could be made unless the plan was linked with an absolute prohibition of atomic weapons.

He declared that the U. S. plan did not link the prohibition of atomic weapons and the banning of arm reduction on basis for a solution.

Gromyko opened debate on the plan later in the day in reply to United States and British demands for action to restore order to the Balkan situation.

No Details of Flying Disk Are Revealed

Roswell Hardware
Man and Wife
Report Disk Seen

The intelligence office of the 10th Bombardment group at Roswell today announced that the field has come into possession of a flying saucer.

According to information released by the department, over intelligence officer, the disk was recovered on a ranch in the Roswell vicinity, after an unidentified rancher had notified Sheriff Geo. Wilcox, here, that he had found the instrument on his premises.

Major Marcel and a detail from his department went to the ranch and recovered the disk; it was stated.

After the intelligence office here had inspected the instrument it was flown to "higher headquarters."

The intelligence office stated that no details of the saucer's construction or its appearance had been revealed.

Mr. and Mrs. Dan Wilcox, who thought was a flying disk, they were sitting on their porch at 105 South Penn last Wednesday night at about 10:30 p. m. when they saw a large glowing object coming out of the sky from the south.



Former King Carol of Romania and Mme. Elena Lupescu relax aboard the S. S. America bound for Cuba and Mexico in May, 1941. A member of Carol's household in Rio de Janeiro said the ex-king and his companion for 23 years in Copacabana Palace suite. (AP Wirephoto)

Some of Soviet Satellites May Attend Paris Meeting

Paris, July 8 (AP)—Indications mounted today that at least some of the nations within the Soviet bloc would attend the Paris conference on the Marshall aid-to-Europe program and a dispatch from Prague quoted Czechoslovak sources as indicating Russia herself might try to get back into the talks.

A Sofia dispatch quoted an authoritative source as saying "probably Bulgaria will participate in the conference which opens in Paris Saturday. The dispatch said the Bulgarian council of ministers was meeting to reach a decision in the matter."

Despite a Moscow radio report that Yugoslavia had rejected the British-French invitation to participate in the Paris conference.

Roswellians Have Differing Opinions On Flying Saucers

Roswell is a bit uncertain about the flying disk, it would appear.

American League Wins All-Star Game

The American League won the All-Star game today, defeating the National League 4 to 3 in the 10th inning.

Roswell Daily Record

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Ramey Empties Roswell Saucer

Sheriff Wilcox Takes Leading Role in Excitement Over Report 'Saucer' Found



Arrest 2,000 In Athens in Commie Plot

Revolution Was
Set to Be Pulled
Off Thursday

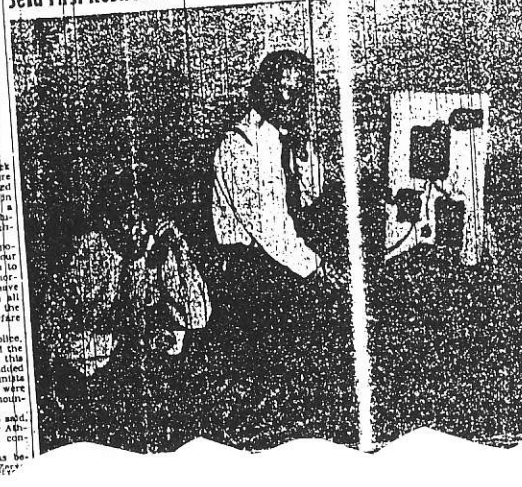
Athens, July 8 (AP)—The Greek government announced today that more than 2,000 persons were arrested in the Athens area early today in connection with a plot to stage a revolution and spread civil war throughout the country.

Minister of Public Order Nikolaos Zervas said the terror had been around 1 a. m. today, when attacks were staged in the parts of Greece, bringing the present mountain guerrilla warfare into urban centers.

Between 1,000 and 4,000 police, gendarmes and soldiers staged the lightning raids before dawn this morning, Zervas said. He added that many important Communists already had fled and others were hiding in Athens or in the mountains.

Most of those arrested, he said, will be taken to islands near Athens, while the investigation continues. Transport already has begun.

Sent First Roswell Wire Photos from Record Office



Ramey Says Excitement Is Not Justified

General Ramey
Says Disk Is
Weather Balloon

Tehran, July 8 (AP)—The flying saucer fever spread today.

Press reports from Zabol, Khosh and Sarbisheh near the Afghan frontier said residents there had observed strange "starlike bodies" in the sky which exploded loudly, leaving a cloud of smoke.

The newspaper Mehr Iran said the objects apparently had something to do with a new weapon, which it dubbed "Zabol."

Fort Worth, Texas, July 8 (AP)—An examination by the army revealed last night that mysterious objects found on a lonely New Mexico ranch was a harmless high-altitude weather balloon, not a grounded flying disk.

Excitement was high until Brig. Gen. Roger M. Vassar, commander of the Eighth air force with headquarters here cleared up the mystery.

The bundle of Unifol, broken wood beams and rubber remnants of a balloon were sent here from an army air transport, in

plained that the find caused him problems in his work. The material, spread out over the field, formed a barrier that the sheep would not cross. According to Tyree, Brazel had to drive the sheep around the debris field to get them to water. That also suggests that whatever had fallen in the field was much larger than the weather balloon suggested by the military.

Descriptions of the material, coming both from Mac Brazel and Jesse Marcel and from those who saw it later, do not agree with what was printed in the newspaper. Bill Brazel, for example, described metal so tough that he couldn't cut it. It was light-weight, like balsa wood, but was much stronger. He has also talked about material that looked somewhat like the fiber optics of today. In taped interviews, Jesse Marcel described metal that was as thin as foil but that couldn't be dented. He related that he and the counter-intelligence officer used a 16-pound sledge hammer without effect.

There was indeed lettering on some of the wreckage, but it was not in English. Jesse Marcel, Jr., described it as geometric symbols. He drew those he could remember on a pad for us. They were embossed on an I-beam and were purplish. The I-beam itself was strong and slightly flexible.

But maybe the most devastating testimony comes from Maj. Marcel. In an interview for a TV documentary he said, "It was not anything from this earth. That I'm quite sure of. Because being in intelligence, I was familiar with all materials used in aircraft and in air travel. This was nothing like this. It could not have been."

Other portions of the newspaper story also fall apart upon examination. The story claims that Brazel was not alone at the ranch when he found the object. According to his son and his neighbors, there was no one at the ranch house other than Mac in June and July 1947. The family was living in Tularosa, New Mexico, then. In fact, Loretta Proctor told us that it was her son who was with Mac when he found the debris. The young Proctor was only seven at the time and remembers almost nothing about it.

In a number of interviews, Bill Brazel told us that not only was his father alone at the ranch, but when Bill read the story in an Albuquerque newspaper, he decided that someone had to go to the ranch to care for the livestock. There was no one there when he arrived on July 12 or 13.

The article claims that Mac Brazel came to Roswell to sell wool when he revealed his find to the sheriff, but Bill Brazel told us that his dad would never have gone into Roswell to sell wool. The ranchers in the area sold their wool to the highest bidder, who then toured ranches shearing the sheep and gathering the wool himself. Brazel did not shear sheep and take the wool anywhere. Moreover, the stockyard where some wool was sold was in Corona, not Roswell.

Finally, for a relatively insignificant event — the discovery of a weather balloon — the Army went to some

trouble to ensure that the new "facts" got out. There are three witnesses who saw Mac Brazel in Roswell on July 9. Floyd Proctor, his closest neighbor, said that Brazel was escorted by several military officers and that he did not acknowledge his friend on the street. Frank Joyce, a reporter for KGFL radio, claimed that Brazel visited him at the station on July 9 and told him a story significantly different from the one he had given on July 6. And Paul McEvoy, editor of the *Roswell Daily Record*, mentioned the military officers who brought Brazel by the newspaper office.

A weather balloon?

Inside the newspaper story from July 9 are a few clues about what the Army was trying to accomplish. On July 5, 1947, Sherman Campbell found a strange object on his farm in Circleville, Ohio. The local sheriff identified it immediately as a weather balloon, and on July 6 there were pictures printed in papers around the country of Mrs. Campbell holding the kitelike structure.

According to the *Roswell Daily Record* of July 9, Brazel, accompanied by Marcel and the counter-intelligence agent, took the material home and tried to make a kite out of it but couldn't get the pieces to fit together. There is no reason for him, or the military officers, to try to make a kite out of it, unless they were constructing a story to parallel the explanation for the Circleville find.

In the following days, the type of explanation changed until the debris was finally identified as a weather balloon with an attached Rawin Target Device, used for estimating the altitude of the balloon. This demonstrates that the balloon explanation hadn't been fully developed at the time Brazel gave his story to the *Daily Record*.

The question that no one asks is how the sheriff in Circleville could identify the balloon but the officers at Roswell were so surprised by their find that they announced the recovery of a flying saucer. Marcel failed to make the identification, but so did Col. William Blanchard, the base commander; so did his staff. No one at Roswell was able to identify the balloon. It had to be flown to Fort Worth where a rather low-ranking officer, Warrant Officer Irving Newton, announced that it was a weather balloon (though he didn't mention the Rawin Target Device).

The facts, again

We have found no facts to dispute in the article of July 8, which announces the discovery of a flying saucer. A rancher in the Roswell area did find something and he did tell Sheriff George A. Wilcox, who did notify authorities at Roswell Army Air Field. The material was loaded on a plane and flown to a higher headquarters just as the story claims. We have even interviewed people

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The Canadian UFO wave of 1989

by Chris Rutkowski

■ ■ Chris Rutkowski, an *IUR* contributing editor, is a curator at the University of Manitoba. He is the author of *Visitations?: Manitoba UFO Experiences* (1989).

During the fall of 1989, a series of local flaps contributed to produce a UFO wave in Canada. It is still too early to obtain a full tally of the report numbers, but we can note that the National Research Council of Canada reported a 100-percent increase in the number of reports received during October 1989. Since the NRC receives only a fraction of the total numbers of reports, the waves must be considered at least highly significant.

Sightings included a few landing traces, some close encounters and at least one interesting daylight disc. What is most curious is that many sightings were reported from Langenburg, Saskatchewan, the location of a noted CE2 case in 1974. (In that year, farmer Edwin Fuhr watched several bowl-shaped objects about 11 feet in diameter creating "nests" in his field. This was one of the most unusual trace cases on record because it occurred during broad daylight and was investigated by RCMP as well as CUFOS representatives.)

There is no question that a contributing precipitor of the Canadian UFO wave was the incredible media attention afforded the Soviet rash of sightings. In the first week of October 1989, international media ridiculed the Russians for reports by Tass that "three-eyed aliens" had invaded a small Russian community some distance from Moscow. A regular media circus erupted, and there were further reports of landing traces outside a large apartment building and a spurious report of a youth's disappearing after being zapped by an alien ray gun. Furthermore, at least one Soviet reporter claimed contact with the aliens, who told him they were from a place called "Red Star" (not surprisingly).

It was in this state of mind that Canadian media carried the Soviet stories, and the Canadian public once again saw UFOs become a discussion topic at the breakfast table. Although the Canadian UFO wave did not get reported until after the Soviet stories were entrenched in people's minds, the Canadian UFO reports actually began earlier than this point.

The Canadian public first learned about UFOs in

Canada after a national television news broadcast carried a story about sightings in Langenburg. Although the news story ran on October 25, the sightings at Langenburg were from two weeks earlier, as investigators discovered. The wave itself began building as a series of apparently unconnected local flaps in western Canada.

In the spring a UFOROM representative in Brandon, Manitoba, was encouraged to investigate a report of a landing trace near the town of Strathclair, about 75 km northwest of his city. When he went to the site in May, he found two groupings of triangular marks in a field. The marks were typically impressions dug into the ground, about 16 inches in diameter, and with smaller holes at the centers of each large impression. These smaller holes were about two inches in diameter and varied between 12 and 30 inches deep. No one in the area had ever seen anything like the marks before, though biologists at Brandon University thought that animal actions were involved. Local people, however, dismissed the notion. There was no UFO observed in connection with the discovery of the marks, but residents were convinced of an "alien" origin.

The first observed UFO of the Winnipeg flap was seen on May 30 at 9:15 p.m., when a man and his son observed a "silvery, metallic hot dog," oriented vertically. The man went to get four other persons and with them watched the object as it moved steadily west. After several minutes, the object was lost in the distance. A check with the weather office showed that there was no wind at the time, so the possibility of a mylar balloon is feasible, but not proven.

The summer was generally quiet, but at the end of July there was a curious report of a power blackout during the sighting of a UFO over a religious commune near Veregin, Saskatchewan. The investigation of this case is continuing, and is hampered by both distance to the area and the hesitation of the witnesses to speak with outsiders.

At the end of August, a woman was driving near La Salle, Manitoba, at about midnight. She reported seeing a "cloudlike boomerang" pass over her car, north of town. This description of a "boomerang" was to become significant in later sightings.

A case that received wide attention in Manitoba was another trace discovered this time near the town of Argyle. About the same time as the La Salle case, two

brothers were cultivating and discovered a ring cut into the tall grass. They left the site and brought their father to look at their find. On September 5, he went to the offices of a local newspaper with his story. A reporter immediately went out to the site and began preparing a news feature. She called the Manitoba Planetarium in Winnipeg, where people tend to report their UFOs, and asked for comments. The planetarium's opinion on the case was printed in the next issue of the paper, and throngs of curiosity-seekers visited the site over the next three weeks. But because the planetarium staff were too busy with their work, no one went out to the site until October 10, when a TV film crew learned of the ring and wanted photos of a UFO investigation for a children's program. The ring was then found to be in a bad state of disturbance, but it turned out that a much fainter second ring overlapping the main one was visible from a high-angle view. The site has been recently likened to the British field rings, though the similarity is minor at best. Once again, no UFO was observed in connection with the incident.

On September 15 at 3:40 a.m., a 59-year-old witness in eastern Winnipeg was looking out her kitchen window when a deltoid object sailed past. It had lines of "Christmas lights" spreading out from its leading edge, and moved silently out of view in four or five seconds.

About this time UFOs were also seen one evening over the city of Vancouver, by two witnesses. Although local investigators have tried to find more observers of the event over such a large population, none have been located.

But it was a few weeks later that the UFOs became more frequent. On October 6, at 11:30 p.m., a woman driving near Tyndall, Manitoba, saw a bright light flash upwards out of sight in front of her car. Then, on October 9, a daylight sighting occurred at 2:50 p.m., at a wildlife sanctuary in an unpopulated area inside the city limits of Winnipeg. A couple and their child were getting into their car when they saw a white "boomerang-shaped" object hanging silently and motionless in the east over the city. In order to "protect" their child, the mother took her into the back seat of the car. The man continued to watch as the object tilted as it turned, revealing a "bulge" on its underside. It moved away, and the family went home.

The sighting that received the most attention in the Winnipeg area began at about 11:15 p.m., on October 9, and ended over two hours later. Carl Weselak, a self-described "volunteer astronomer," decided that he would observe a meteor shower from his third-floor apartment window in downtown Winnipeg. Almost immediately, he saw a large "boomerang-shaped" object flying north to south over the city. He was keeping accurate time for his meteor observing, and therefore knew this occurred at 11:30 p.m. exactly. Its angular size was thought to be about 1/8-inch at arm's length. Over the next few hours, other UFOs were seen, ranging from balls of light to the now-familiar boomerang. He was sure that none were

aircraft, but were indeed extraterrestrial spacecraft.

The case received publicity because as he watched the objects, he telephoned a newspaper to have a reporter verify the sightings. A major article appeared a few days later, after reporters had interviewed Weselak and received comments from planetarium representatives. Investigation by UFOFORUM showed that the airport had never been called regarding flight plans of aircraft about the time of the sightings. It turns out that several landings and take-offs over Winnipeg corresponded to the minute with Weselak's observations. (This does not mean, however, that the sightings are fully explained in this manner, and both UFOFORUM and the planetarium are still checking further with airport officials regarding certain details.)

This was enough to spark a local media furor about UFOs. Several more sightings were reported throughout the week to media and investigators. But unknown to Winnipeg residents, the wave had moved westward. The same night as Carl Weselak's multiple sightings, two radio announcers in Dawson Creek, British Columbia, were alerted to some lights in the night sky. They went and watched an object that "did not seem to be an airplane" move silently in the night sky.

On October 11, at 7:30 p.m., a group of five elementary school children skateboarding in Langenburg, Saskatchewan, suddenly saw an arrangement of colored lights moving toward them across a field. One boy told reporters, "It sort of came down when it saw us. It seemed to come to a stop, and then it took off." The five boys instinctively ducked down in some tall grass because they feared they would be "abducted." When the object moved off, they went to tell two of their teachers nearby in the schoolyard. Together, they all watched the object for another 10 or 15 minutes. One of the teachers said that the object had a "bright flashing light on top and a red light on the bottom." It appeared to him to be over a kilometer away, but only 200 meters in altitude. The top light appeared to flash on and off every 15 to 20 seconds.

That same night, Edwin Fuhr had his second UFO sighting in 15 years when he, too, saw "colored lights in the sky." And in Winnipeg, about 400 km away, a shift worker was returning home through a park at about 12:20 a.m. when he saw a "shimmering boomerang" in the sky. He went closer, and he heard a high-pitched whine coming from its direction. As he walked closer, it started to move slowly, then shot away, making a noise like a "sonic boom."

The sighting that drew the most attention in Saskatchewan occurred on October 13. At 10:00 a.m. Rose Neumeier was in her kitchen, talking on the telephone and blankly looking out a window. A flash of light drew her attention toward a shed about 15 meters from the farmhouse. An object "like two pie plates rim to rim" was motionless in the air only about 15 meters above the

shed. It appeared nine meters long and three meters thick, with a flattened top and a "corrugated" bottom. It was shiny and metallic, and light was shining brightly from the "joint" between the two halves. It made no noise and animals were not disturbed. After a few minutes, the object "rose in slow motion. It went north of the yard, curved through the hayfield, then circled over the barn and went back across the pasture."

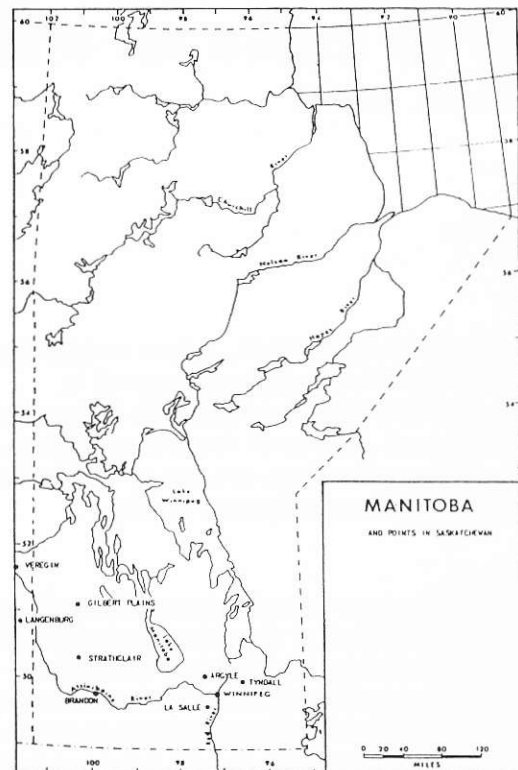
Three days later, a woman was driving near Langruth, Manitoba, at about 7:45 a.m., when she saw a "star with a tail of smoke going up" in the eastern sky. After a few minutes the object took on the appearance of a "dome shape," and its tail was no longer visible. Twelve hours later, a man in Langenburg was driving with his daughter when they observed an object in the night sky. The object was "as wide as a small airplane is long," with colored flashing lights. As they watched, it coasted over the highway "right over our heads." It made no sound, and they were both mystified. This sighting spurred the man to watch the sky every night after that, and he made several additional reports during the rest of the month.

According to RCMP, a "reliable" resident of Gilbert Plains, Manitoba, observed a large object with red flashing lights on October 25 at 7:45 p.m. It moved slowly and silently at an estimated altitude of 60 meters and did not appear to be an aircraft.

Finally, the last case of the major part of the wave was called in to UFOROM on November 1. At 6:50 p.m., a pilot flying a small plane 20 miles north of La Ronge, Saskatchewan, reported seeing a pair of blinking lights moving across his path at an altitude of 8500 feet. Air Traffic Control confirmed that there were no other aircraft known in the area at the time.

The geographical spread of the reports throughout the wave is very interesting. Sightings were made hundreds of kilometers apart within a matter of hours or days of each other, without any way for the witnesses to know of the other cases. This in itself is unusual, though there may be a number of contributing elements. First, the Soviet media circus probably raised people's awareness of UFOs. Second, a little-known meteor shower (Draconids) peaked on October 9-10, and it is possible that some sightings could be traceable to this cause. Yet a better known shower peaked on October 21 (Orionids), and this did not precipitate any reports.

Another possible explanation that should be mentioned is the TST (Tectonic Strain Theory of UFOs). This theory attempts to link UFOs and the release of seismic energy, and good correlations have been claimed, though disputed. The San Francisco earthquake occurred on October 17, admittedly during the 1989 wave. It has been suggested that the wave was an indication of pending seismic release, but how and why the energy manifested itself over 1500 kilometers from the earthquake epicenter are questions that need answering before the two can be considered related through anything other than coincidence.



Finally, the Canadian wave had counterparts throughout North America, and it will be interesting to assess the full scope of UFO phenomena observed during the fall of 1989. Ufologists will have plenty of new data to study in the coming years. As usual, many of the reports appear likely to have conventional explanations, while still others require more information for analysis. A few do not seem to have simple explanations, and those will be examined in the months ahead.

Investigators and researchers are encouraged to share their case reports with each other for a better understanding of the wave. And debunkers are invited to submit their comments and case investigations to add to the analyses. Even if the UFOs all have conventional explanations, the wave is at least interesting to sociologists, to understand the mechanisms of its formation, and the reasons people across two nations suddenly began reporting UFOs again. ■

Coming in *IUR*...

Roswell: the rest of the story
by Don Schmitt and Kevin D. Randle

Lost in Magonia
by Jerome Clark

How to make an alien

by Thomas E. Bullard

■ ■ Thomas E. Bullard, Ph.D., writes frequently for *IUR*. His articles have also appeared in *Magonia*, *MUFON UFO Journal*, *UFO*, *Journal of UFO Studies* and *Journal of American Folklore*. He is the author of the two-volume *UFO Abductions: The Measure of a Mystery* (1987).

Faraway places have more than faraway names in the annals of human belief. From time immemorial we have populated lands beyond the horizon with teeming imaginary creatures unlike ourselves, and listened avidly to the most outlandish tales about inhabitants of distant places. Out of sight always has licensed belief in out of the ordinary. This principle seems to run throughout history as a constant, and UFO occupants represent the latest version of this trend.

No element of the UFO mystery piques our curiosity like those occupants. If UFOs are spaceships, they must have pilots, and reports over the years have tantalized us with glimpses of these beings or even accounts of more extensive contact. Abduction reports in particular are full of clues about the appearance, behavior, nature and purposes of seemingly alien life forms.

Eyewitness reports are almost exclusively our source of information about visiting aliens. This situation is clearly less than ideal. Abduction witnesses gain the longest and closest view, but they often claim mental impairment effects. Even without this handicap, these people are understandably surprised or frightened, and such an emotional state is hardly optimal for careful observation. Most of us are sloppy observers under the best of circumstances. Before you dismiss this claim, try an experiment: Look across the room and estimate the size of an object, then measure it. If your experience is like mine, you will learn a small lesson in doubt, also humility.

UFO witnesses take on a far more difficult task in reporting their observations. Whatever else a UFO may be, it is not a familiar piece of furniture. A UFO belongs to the unknown, and UFO occupants doubly so. Observers of the unknown find themselves cast adrift from the usual moorings of experience and deprived of the standard points of reference. By its very nature the unknown defies identification with the familiar, and escapes the bounds of words as we normally use them.

Describing the unknown means resorting to metaphor and approximation; understanding the unknown means guesswork and stabs in the dark.

The UFO observer must wrangle with a sight that fits no familiar category and then find words to convey the experience to others. Somewhere in between the observer must reckon with another problem. No one comes innocent to the subject of UFOs these days. Everyone knows something about them, how they are supposed to look, what they are supposed to do, who is supposed to occupy them. This burden of preconceptions imposes a maze of potentially distorting images, theories and terminology between the observation and its final expression. A constant concern of ufologists must be how much a final report reflects the initial observations, and how much it refracts them through a tradition of preconceptions.

Here is where a look at changing concepts of the alien has a valuable lesson to offer. An understanding of how the human imagination has visualized aliens in the past can reveal principles still at work in visualizing aliens today, and guide us to clearer judgment about what we can or cannot accept in current reports of UFO aliens.

The original traveler's tale is Homer's *Odyssey*. In Books 9-12 Odysseus recounts his adventures and hardships on the way home after the fall of Troy. Blown off course into uncharted waters, he encounters a series of exotic beings. Among them are the Lotus Eaters, whose song is so beautiful that sailors lose their will to resist the sound and follow it to destruction. Circe the witch turns Odysseus' crew into swine. The Cyclopes are giants possessed of a single eye; without laws or manners, they eat human flesh. Far more courteous is Aeolus, who captures the winds in a bag, but he has committed the moral outrage of marrying his sons to his daughters. Odysseus meets the Cimmerians, a people who live in a land of perpetual darkness, and visits the subterranean land of the dead. Strange places, strange creatures, and strange powers are themes associated with things alien ever since.

When Alexander the Great invaded India in 327 B.C., he entered the most distant and fabled of all countries known to the Greeks. Marvelous accounts of the wonderful people there already had filtered back to Greece, but such tales multiplied after his campaign and established a tradition of beliefs that would persist for the

next 2000 years. A race of hairy dog-headed people (Cynocephali) lived in the mountains of India and communicated by barking. The big-eared people (Pano-tii) could wrap themselves in their ears as if in a blanket, or even fly with them. The Sciritae had flat faces and no nose. Members of another race, called the Sciopoda, shaded themselves from the sun by raising their single leg and blocking the light with their huge foot. Giants, Cyclopes, Amazons, and hairy beings were common in India, as were Pygmies. These diminutive people are perhaps the most universal of all marvelous races.

The Roman author Pliny the Elder, who died in the eruption of Vesuvius in A.D. 79, gathered accounts of many wonderful races in his *Natural History*. He added reports from beyond the fringes of the Roman world, some coming from the Baltic regions to the north, others eastward from the Caucasus, still others from Libya and Ethiopia to the south, in fulfillment of the Greek proverb that "there is always something new out of Africa." His book included the Blemmyae, people with faces on their chests but no heads or necks. The Gymnosophisti stood in fire all day and looked up at the sun. A race called the Abarimon had feet that pointed backward, the Anthropophagi ate human flesh, the Androgini had the genitals of both male and female. One race went about on all fours, another bore children at age five and died at eight.

Monstrous races are by no means limited to Western sources. The *Shan Hai Ching* (Classic of the Mountains and the Seas), a Chinese mythological geography from the third century B.C., catalogues many types of monstrous people and bizarre animals. Among the humans are tribes of little people, one-eyed people, hairy people, three-handed people, bird-headed people, and one-armed people. Members of other tribes breathe fire or have holes through the chest. Though culturally isolated, Eastern and Western accounts settled on similar inhabitants for the wild and distant places of the earth.

More than earthly mileage measured the geography of the alien in ancient times. Gods and spirits assumed monstrous forms as well. Many ancient Egyptian gods combined a human body with the head of an animal such as a jackal, lion or ibis. Greek mythology included centaurs, horses with human torsos; harpies, birds with the heads of women; and the Minotaur, a giant human body with the head of a bull. Scorpion Men guarded the gateway where the sun rose and set in the Sumerian *Epic of Gilgamesh*, and souls of the dead in the Sumerian underworld had wings, while this trait attached to angels in the Judeo-Christian tradition. According to Genesis and the Book of Enoch, angels mated with earthly women and the offspring had such great size that "there were giants in the earth in those days." Religious beliefs often populate the world with good and evil spirits such as angels, demons and jinn, beings capable of assuming material form and a variety of appearances, some alluring and some horrifying. The dead also traffic between the earth and their abode, be it the tomb, the underworld or

heaven. These beings are material or quasi-material and variable in appearance.

A belief that humans share their immediate environment with other sentient beings is almost universal in world folklore. Every rock, tree, lake or stream has its spirit, according to many beliefs, and whole populations of beings live side by side with humans yet remain invisible most of the time. Diminutive supernatural beings are found in the folklore of almost every people. The fairy beliefs of Celtic countries include tall, beautiful and godlike beings, small but still humanly proportioned beings, and also a great many grotesque creatures. Among these latter are brownies, usually described as short, hairy and unkempt beings regarded as somewhat subhuman. The fachan has one leg, one eye, an ugly face, and a single hand emerging from his chest. Bogies are mischievous and sometimes dangerous shape-shifters, able to assume both pleasant and monstrous forms. Other fairies are strictly monstrous and destructive, especially water monsters. In German countries dwarfs serve many of the same functions as fairies in Celtic lands, but dwarfs retain more properties of a human race. These beings are skilled but seldom magical; they dwell underground and their distinctive physical traits include shortness, hairiness, and crippled feet that nevertheless are capable of running at extraordinary speed.

Interactions between this world and the alien other-world are uncommon but always possible. In folk conceptions these realms are adjacent and at some times or places come into contact. Thus at Halloween the dead may walk or the fairies disport themselves before mortal eyes. Certain spots like fairy mounds are frequent points of contact with the otherworld, while mountains or the horizon may mark the juncture between heaven and earth. In some beliefs a great tree reaches with its roots into the underworld even while its upper branches enter into heaven, providing a convenient depot for travel between realms. Traveler's tales often portray distant places as magical lands of unearthly beauty and supernatural peril, accessible only by extraordinary means. Medieval Irish accounts of magical voyages described heroes sailing westward and coming to fairyland islands, and the German verse epic of Duke Ernest sent him to eastern lands described in terms of fairyland motifs and inhabited by Crane Men as well as the familiar Sciopods and Panotii of travel literature.

Greek and Roman tales of monstrous races influenced both Arabic civilization and the Medieval world. In the *Arabian Nights* Sinbad the Sailor met these beings in his fictitious travels. In the 1360s Sir John Mandeville, an Englishman who described travels beyond the known world but perhaps never suffered the inconvenience of leaving his writing desk, wrote one of the most widely-read and influential books of the Middle Ages. His adventures took him farther afield in Africa and Asia than his Classical sources, but again in the remotest corners of

the world he found the dog-headed people, the Sciopods, and Pygmies.

Discovery of the New World presented European imaginations with a blank map to fill with wonders, and the explorers of America were careful not to disappoint their audience. Besides golden cities and natives with magical powers, the familiar monstrous races soon gained a foothold throughout the new lands. At the same time a crisis was developing for these beliefs. Odysseus could find his aliens in the Mediterranean, Alexander in India; but Mandeville had to go to China or the source of the Nile to make their acquaintance, and his successors had to seek in still more distant places. As the world became better known, room on earth for imaginary peoples was running out. The legitimate travels of Marco Polo in the late 13th Century included accounts of traditional marvels, but his reference to Dog-heads was more of a descriptive convention than an assertion about a separate race, and he exposed some bodies of supposed Pygmies as dead monkeys used to delude the credulous. Things once taken for fabulous became mundane in a familiar world.

Exploration drove the monstrous races to the ever-dwindling remote corners of the world, where even now dwell Yetis or Mokele Mbembe, and rationalism drove fairies into the realm of folklore. People still insisted on their aliens. The sea could harbor sea serpents and mermaids, islands could remain remote and untouched enough to satisfy Jules Verne or harbor King Kong, but some adjustments had to be made. Distance in time became one compensation for a world grown too small. Ancient times offered possibilities for advanced civilizations and unconventional beings, so a literature on lost continents began to proliferate in the last century, and stories of giant Indian skeletons turned up by a farmer's plow were popular in newspapers of a hundred years ago. The inner earth offered another option. From holes at the poles to Mount Shasta, from Bulwer Lytton's *The Coming Race* to the Pellucidar of Edgar Rice Burroughs and the deros of Richard Shaver, the idea of a nearby but hidden world harboring outlandish beings has flourished in popular beliefs and literature.

As human imagination outgrew its home planet, speculations about outer space opened a boundless home for alien life. Belief in extraterrestrials is nothing new. Certain Greek religious systems committed the souls of the dead to the various planets. Christian thinkers reasoned that God created nothing without high purpose and created all heavenly bodies the same, so all stars and planets must be inhabited. William Herschel, the discoverer of Uranus, contemplated what might live on that planet as well as on the sun. These beliefs persisted into the 19th Century, and even after astronomers knew the planets were unlike in conditions, a faith in the adaptiveness of living things preserved a conviction that life would find a way anywhere and everywhere.

Later in the 19th Century such a belief became hard

to maintain, but by 1877 the discovery of "canals" on Mars convinced many people that advanced beings populated at least one other planet. The astronomer Percival Lowell speculated that Martians would be tall, owing to weaker gravity on their planet, while H.G. Wells applied the theory of evolution to his invaders in *The War of the Worlds* and arrived at creatures that were all brain and hand, huge heads with atrophied digestive systems. These rationalistic speculations gave way to the exuberant imaginings of science-fiction writers and Hollywood studios as they populated the known and unknown universe with humans, humanoids, and monsters of every description.

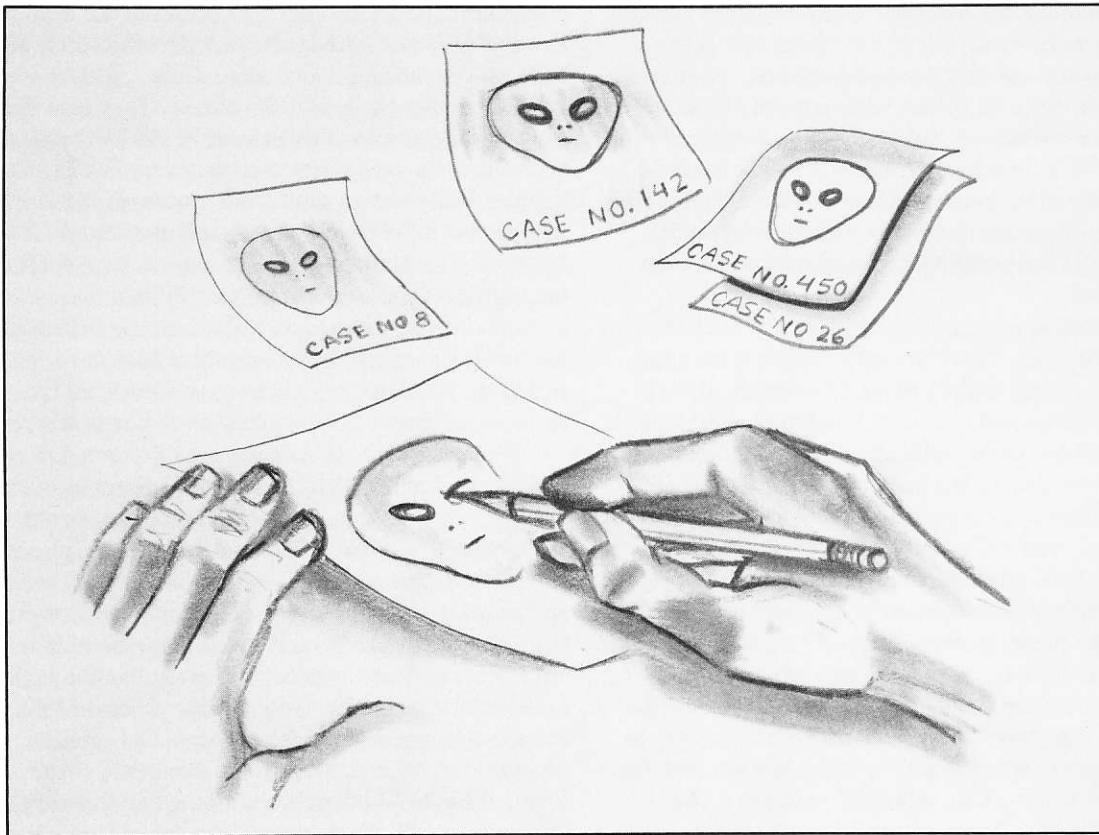
Even in space the process of rejecting the familiar has begun. Early in this century most scientists abandoned the solar system as a probable home of intelligent life, though writers, moviemakers and contactees heard the message only later. With space probes spying out the far side of the moon, surveying the surface of Mars, and giving even distant Neptune a once-over, the solar system has lost too much of its mystery and remoteness to serve as a convincing hideout for aliens. Their home has moved outward to Zeta Reticuli or some such place where no prying eye intrudes on the romance of faraway.

Examples of the human love affair with "otherness" could multiply, but these few illustrations hint at the duration and depth of the commitment. Aliens in flourishing variety have found a home in every culture and every age. Despite all their diversity, these aliens retain a certain familiarity across geography and history. No search of the unconscious is necessary to uncover a reason for this sameness, because it lies mostly in the way we create out aliens. Alienness begins with the human norm of appearance, customs, and abilities. A few general principles then operate to modify the familiar, and operate the same way whenever people visualize strange beings, so the results have identical starting-points and principles in common even though details may differ. These principles amount to a set of rules for creating an alien.

(1) *Appearance*. Three techniques working singly or in combination can account for most aliens of extraordinary appearance, from cute ones like "E.T." (sometimes described as a shelled turtle) to the most repellent monster.

(a) *Exaggeration*. In the art of alien-making, nothing succeeds like excess. Carry certain physical features or tendencies to an extreme, such as height to create a giant or Pygmy, ear size to make the Panotii, or hairiness to outfit feral beings and brownies.

(b) *Distortion*. Recombine ordinary features into something odd or monstrous. A being reduced to one eye becomes a Cyclops, to one leg a Sciopod or fachen. Flatten the face and remove the nose and the result is the Sciritae, or relocate the facial features on the chest to make a Blemmyae.



(c) *Chimerization*. Join various human and animal parts into a single creature; for instance, a human with bird's wings becomes an angel, a horse with a human make a centaur, a dog's head on a human body equals the Cynocephali. Animal-to-animal combinations make up a vast menagerie of imaginary beasts not discussed here, such as the griffin or unicorn.

(2) *Personality*. Here too exaggeration, distortion and chimerization shape the descriptions. A preference for extremes of virtuousness or turpitude is apparent when travel tales speak of faraway races as upright and just, exemplary in some quality like courtesy or generosity. Fairies and dwarfs often abide by a strict code of etiquette, and expect humans to do the same. Other strange beings are purely destructive and evil, bereft of any redeeming quality whatever. Polyphemus the Cyclops behaved as the wholly evil monster, since he respected neither men nor gods, had no manners, and ate human flesh. A common compromise between these extremes is a being in which good qualities juxtapose with bad to form a grotesque and disturbing whole. The fairies frequently combine a positive side of beauty, grace and courtesy with a negative side of ruthlessness toward anyone who offends them, however innocently. These sharp contrasts lend a danger to alien beings, and enhance their alienness. They personify our angelic along with our bestial qualities, and bind these opposites so closely together that the combination seems incongruous,

inexplicable, and ultimately unhuman.

(3) *Powers*. Exaggerated physical or cultural abilities characterize alien beings, exaggerated natural conditions their environment. Faraway races might live ordinary or even savage lives, but the beings often possess some extraordinary quality like great strength or an ability to run unusually fast. The commonest abilities are magical powers, like Aeolus' command over the winds or the illusion-making talents of fairies. Dwarfs demonstrated a skill in craftsmanship that verged on the supernatural, while Atlanteans and subterraneans supposedly possessed the lost knowledge of an advanced science. Wonderful beings lived in wonderful surroundings. The Lotus Eaters lost memory and care because of their diet; Mandeville found the Fountain of Youth on his travels, and Ponce de Leon searched for it in Florida. Medieval travelers sought the kingdom of Prester John, a mythical Christian monarch of a vast and mighty kingdom in central Asia or Ethiopia. Other explorers of the New World looked for El Dorado, a place of surpassing wealth, and races living in the most desolate places were imagined to possess endless supplies of gold and jewels. Other beings lived in perpetual darkness or cold. Again anything alien is likely to be imagined in superlatives, either of wonder and beauty or of desolation and ugliness.

(4) *Remoteness*. One requisite property of aliens precedes all others — a place of origin distant enough to lend plausibility to the beings themselves. Aliens always

make their home in the distance. The further the traveler journeyed from his everyday surroundings, the stranger sights he saw and the stranger beings he met. Familiarity ruins the faith, since no matter what you may think of your neighbor's pedigree, you know him too well to believe that he is literally dog-headed. The land of the alien must lie well beyond experience, where imagination can stretch without bumping into inconvenient reality. There all things are possible, and monsters become the expected norm.

UFO aliens as pictured in abduction reports fit snugly within this formula. These occupants come from a far planet where current beliefs based on scientific theory anticipate different and unknown life-forms. The typical alien is a short humanoid with an enlarged cranium and eyes, otherwise diminished facial features and no hair. Here the process of exaggeration is apparent. For the enlarged head, frail body, and lack of hair, reference to popular images of progressive evolution can explain these traits, since higher development of the brain comes at the expense of the physical, more "animal" traits of the body.

Of course UFO occupants possess remarkable powers. The science and technology of these beings are so advanced that they border on the magical. Simply to reach earth across space attests to their abilities, and their abduction activities reflect scientific curiosity. The ability of these beings to manipulate human minds or the physical environment during an abduction further demonstrates their advancement beyond human capabilities.

Personality contradictions are commonplace among the abductors. They express themselves with a great deal of courtesy and assure the captive that the abduction is necessary, even crucial for some vague but altruistic project to save the earth or the aliens. At the same time abductees sense insincerity and indifference. Most of all, they feel used. Apologies and reassurances come cheaply from beings who are determined to capture humans against their will and subject them to frightening, painful experiences. Altruistic pretenses clash so harshly with unethical practices that the beings seem to share few human values. These aliens remain steeped in their alienness.

Where does the old alien end and the new alien begin? Easy answers are not forthcoming, and fateful consequences follow. Abduction reports are remarkably alike in order and content. One explanation attributes these similarities to different persons sharing a similar experience, another to a combination of social and psychological factors preparing various individuals to share similar fantasies. If abduction reports were like nothing else but one another, their objectivity would be hard to deny. The less unique this phenomenon becomes, the more reasonable a subjective origin seems.

UFO aliens clearly have a great deal in common with their worldly and otherworldly predecessors. Identical

processes can account for descriptions of the new as well as the old. If one foundation underlies the surely fictitious and the allegedly real alike, little credence seems justified in the reality of UFO aliens. They lose their uniqueness and join other aspects of the UFO phenomenon which, as researchers such as Hilary Evans and Jacques Vallee have pointed out, resemble accounts widespread in folklore, religion and mythology. These sometimes striking similarities are mainstays supporting the psychological explanation for UFOs, a theory favored by many French ufologists, writers for the British journal *Magonia*, and even some researchers here in darkest America. Finding UFO aliens bear significant likenesses to aliens unrelated to UFOs only strengthens this position.

Aliens — in the broadest sense of others different and distant from ourselves — offer a microcosmic test of the appeal to folklore as an explanation for abductions. These beings visit us from a variety of times, places, and cultural settings, so we view alien beliefs from many perspectives and have ample opportunity to recognize legitimate patterns. No controversial premise of innate archetypes or forms is necessary to explain the looks and customs of aliens, since a formulatic process of the imagination can account for the observed patterns. This process is so plain that a few can express it. Most importantly, UFO aliens share a long list of parallels with other aliens. All the necessary ingredients are present and ambiguities are at a minimum, so if a folkloric explanation works for any UFO phenomena, it ought to work here.

At first glance, and maybe after a second or third, the parallels between UFO and other aliens remain hard to dismiss as meaningless. Neither should we dismiss this evidence simply because it clashes with a favored explanation. Anyone with an ounce of curiosity must ask why a self-respecting alien would borrow his good looks, such as they are, from some rumor-mongering Medieval liar or Celtic folk tradition. The idea that all imaginary aliens originated in sightings of the real thing is even less plausible. Understood in terms of recurrent processes of imagination, UFO occupants scarcely pose a problem at all. They become no more than an updated version of an age-old tendency to exaggerate and distort the inhabitants of unfamiliar places.

Real aliens are superfluous where imagination can do the job unassisted, so the key question must be whether the imagination truly works alone or accepts a helping from reality. At this point social and psychological factors seem able to go it alone, but closer inspection leaves some serious doubts.

The idea that folklore must be false is a misconception and needs correction from the start. True, many folk narratives are third-person accounts heard from a "friend of a friend" and deserving of no credence. A good story will circulate and change with the telling as each narrator adds improvements and personal touches, sometimes to the benefit and sometimes to the detriment of the story,

but always to its modification. Before long any truth in the initial account is likely to disappear or alter beyond all recognition. Other folk narratives, like many UFO reports, originate with the observer. The audience receives a first-person account of the alleged experience, without the distortions of hand-me-down transmission. Of course personal experience is fraught with opportunities for alteration as the narrator borrows from traditions and expectations to shape the account, make the mysterious comprehensible, and present the narrator as he wishes himself seen. Even the inner route through the mind of a single individual is hazardous for truth.

In most instances a search for the origin of folk narratives is a waste of time, and worse, an exercise in self-deception. Folklorists of the past built elaborate theoretical explanations for the origins of myths and tales, only to discover in light of subsequent knowledge that all this effort was futile, that every tie to demonstrable origins had dissolved in the continuous wash of creative rethinking.

Origins still close to personal experience offer more encouraging prospects. When folklorist David Hufford studied the "Old Hag" tradition in Newfoundland, he heard many accounts of supernatural assault by a nocturnal being that entered the bedrooms of witnesses and oppressed or paralyzed them so that they could scarcely breathe for several minutes. The usual folkloric explanation for a personal experience of this sort stresses its cultural origins. A tradition of Old Hag visitations teaches people to expect such visits. Difficulties in breathing during the night may trigger a dream or fantasy involving the elements of this tradition, the result is a claimed visit from the Old Hag, and yet another report reaffirms the belief among hearers who are prepared then to share in this psychological experience at some future time.

When Hufford returned to Pennsylvania and began describing his research in class, he received a shock. Several students came forward to say that they had experienced a similar encounter. What surprised him was that none of these students came from Newfoundland or ever heard of the Old Hag tradition; yet they described the same phenomena. These students had never reported the experience because they had no name for it, no traditional framework for understanding the frightening events. Like many abductees, these students kept silent to avoid ridicule and suspicion of insanity. He came to suspect a form of sleep paralysis as the underlying cause of these experiences.

The conventional wisdom of folklorists allowed extranormal experiences to be only consequences of tradition. Hufford's evidence turned cause and effect around and showed that tradition might derive from experience. The revolution would not overthrow expectations as an important element in observations and reports — most UFOs are still IFOs, most ghosts just wisps of fog. What matters is that the relationship can

run two ways, and experience might play a larger role than folklorists imagine in creating and sustaining tradition. His findings deny the absolute power of tradition in extranormal encounters, and restore faith in the witness as a potentially valid reporter of experience.

Regarded in this light, the "aliens" recorded by ancient travelers lose some of their fancifulness. The dog-headed people were most likely baboons, the Sciopods based on Indian yogis sitting in an acrobatic position and seeming to shade themselves with one foot. The Blemmyae may have worn armor depicting the human face on their chests, or tattoos presenting a similar picture. Some peoples are taller or shorter than others, and within any population gigantism and dwarfism can occur, so the basis for giants and Pygmies could be experiential. Many of the monstrous races identify in a plausible way with actual people.

Still, descriptions of strange beings and places owe a great deal to imagination and the development of a tradition. Medieval travelers such as Mandeville did not see baboons or dog-headed people, but simply borrowed from Pliny and other traditional sources. A pattern of imagination appears to have worked throughout history and in China as well as the West, suggesting a universal scope. This process shows every sign of vigorous activity today in the creation of literary and movie aliens.

Given the difficulties in coming to mental grips with a novel and frightening situation, an individual who really encountered aliens might well fall back on the time-honored intellectual supports offered by traditional processes and ideas. The situation would overwhelm calm and dispassionate judgment. In the scramble to make sense out of the unknown and communicate some likeness of an incredible experience, the witness might exaggerate and distort certain aspects, or mix unfamiliar impressions with familiar but inaccurate ideas. Exaggerated aliens might better convey the strangeness and wonder of the experience, but at a price. Extremes lack nuance, so these aliens would lose something of themselves, part of their uniqueness and the exactitude of a clinical description. We can only speak of aliens in human terms. The speaker must add something of himself to the experience and subtract something of the unknown other, so the result is always a partial truth.

Though some changes are inevitable, we have reason to believe that they may not be very extensive or serious. What remains the nemesis of psychological proponents and the hope of objectivists is a surprising consistency among UFO aliens. They range from Venusians to 10-foot tall monsters with a variety of other shapes and forms thrown in between, but the short hairless humanoid with large eyes and no hair predominates in honest reports. Even abduction aliens differ in appearance; yet the short humanoid is most common by far. His looks and personality reappear down to small details in case after case and provoke a sense of amazement that so

many people could imagine the same thing.

A critic might object that Dog-heads and Sciopods persisted unchanged for some 2000 years. True, but these creatures passed along a written tradition. Pliny's writings were part of the education of all literate persons, so his description was familiar to travel writers and they took it up with deliberate intent. UFO aliens seem to look the same even to people little versed in UFO lore.

So little variance among UFO aliens is the most surprising aspect of all. Pliny records an extensive array of strange races, fairies come in a wide variety of appearances. Exotic forms for extraterrestrials proliferate in science-fiction literature and movies. With the boundless opportunities of outer space for a background and Hollywood setting the example, abductees ought to spice their stories with some variety of visitors. These people should be especially productive of diverse aliens if, as many psychological proponents have argued, abductees are fantasy-prone by nature and therefore more fluent than average in imagination.

Just how contrary this stability is to the normal dynamics of folk tradition cannot be overemphasized. Variation is a central characteristic of folklore, one of its essential qualities. Nothing requires UFO aliens to be short humanoids; in fact, the familiarity of bug-eyed monsters and diverse popular images of aliens from the mass media should push even the dullest imagination toward variety. Abductees would have to study the abduction literature with a curious single-mindedness to learn the "proper" alien description, then conspire with other abductees to stick with the same image. Other folk narrators are usually stubborn about their creative rights, and it is hard to believe that a hypnotist or familiarity with abduction reports alone could influence so many individuals to limit themselves to such a narrow range of descriptions.

The final improbability of the folkloric solution is the two conflicting claims its proponents ask us to accept. We must swallow reports that have the content of folklore, but not the dynamics of folklore. True, UFO aliens resemble other aliens, but the materials of folklore are so vast and diverse that a diligent search can find some look-alike for just about anything. The alien tradition is so polymorphous that to speak of it in the singular misrepresents its true complexity. How so many abductees thread their way so unerringly along one strand of that tradition becomes a formidable challenge to psychosocial proponents, if they would face the consequences of their assumptions. The dynamics of folklore provide a more crucial test than resemblances, and UFO alien reports show little sign of acting like typical folk narratives. Quite the contrary, so little variation in evidence when so much should be expected gives good reason to doubt that abduction reports are folklore, or else to believe that folklore works in an uncanny way with these narratives and these alone.

Escape from the typical psychosocial labyrinth is

possible. If witnesses actually observe the aliens they describe, then we have an easy answer for why imaginary aliens show all the variety that their place of origin implies, while UFO aliens do not. One sample lies close to experience, one far from it. The two samples differ in origin and any elements of comparison are coincidental. Recurrent first-person accounts of complex events are more appropriate for recall of experience than for the operation of imagination, and abduction reports are certainly recurrent in sequence and content. Minor differences may trace to social influences and psychological processes, but the larger consistencies point in the opposite direction.

All the votes are not yet counted on whether abduction reports are really as consistent as those now in literature would indicate. Even if the consistency persists, it cannot prove that extraterrestrials exist. It only challenges proponents of a folkloric solution to demonstrate how similarities of content are significant in the absence of similarities in dynamics. Half an answer still leaves an equally large question. From a folklorist's point of view, the ability of people to report extranormal experiences with some accuracy conforms to present understanding, but the ability to preserve complex narratives without variation does not. One abductee after another tells about the same old aliens with no more imaginative embellishment than someone who describes riders on the morning bus. Odysseus and Mandeville knew a good tale and knew how to tell it: maybe abductees just know their aliens. ■

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Letter

To the editor:

I would like to correct Chris Rutkowski's remark (September/October *IUR*) to the effect that "Druffel and D. Scott Rogo have speculated that abductees transfer emotional stresses into emotional fantasies."

This theory, which I first outlined in *The Tujunga Canyon Contacts*, is not shared by Ann Druffel. It was because Ann and I were coming to different conclusions on the nature of UFO entities that we wrote separate concluding chapters to the book. Nor is it correct to say that I believe that UFO-abduction experiences are fantasies. I have long maintained that such experiences are real and objective but that the *theme* of the event will be based on information withdrawn from the subject's mind by some X intelligence.

I wish to note that ever since first writing on the abduction mystery, I have taken pains to emphasize that my provisional theory does not reject the *physicality* of these encounters. Why this part of my theory has been so often misinterpreted remains an enigma to me.

D. Scott Rogo
Northridge, California

Machinelike underground sounds and UFO phenomena

by Greg Long

■ ■ Greg Long is a researcher and writer who lives in Oregon.

I want to thank Thomas R. Adams, Tommy Roy Blann, Graham Conway, Lucius Farish, Stan Friedman, Stan Gordon, Robert Neeley, Chris Rutkowski and the Yakima fire lookouts for their help in the making of this article.

From 1981 to 1986 I investigated and researched a concentration of UFO sightings (nearly 200) that occurred between 1964 and 1984 on the Yakima Indian Reservation in south-central Washington. My complete findings will be published in the near future. One significant fact to note now, however, is reports of machinelike "underground sounds" on the reservation. During my Yakima investigations I also discovered similar accounts of these sounds from other distant locations.

On one hand, these puzzling sounds suggest effects of tectonic strain and earthquake activity; yet the prevalence of reports of UFOs, Bigfoot and other strange phenomena in the vicinity of the sounds may suggest a more complex answer. If the sounds are proved to be linked to seismicity, however, other explanations must be sought for the reports of anomalous activity in the local areas. (All italics in the quoted material are my own, unless otherwise noted.)

Yakima Indian Reservation

The Yakima Indian Reservation is faulted. In fact, Toppenish Ridge, along which many UFOs were seen (mostly nocturnal lights), features nearly 100 separate faults spanning 19 miles.

During the heaviest period of UFO sightings (the early to mid-1970s), the fire lookouts — who provided 118 of the total reports — began detecting strange sounds. W.J. (Bill) Vogel, the Chief Fire Control Officer and the chief UFO investigator on the reservation, reported for the first time (November 7, 1972) that the fire lookout on Satus Peak, at the western end of Toppenish Ridge, had been hearing "deep rumbling noises" which seemed to come from under the lookout station.

Vogel described the sounds as "similar to a loaded

truck pulling a long hill and never reaching the top, or the kind of rumblings one sometimes associates with an earthquake." He reported that the lookout heard the sounds only during the daytime, and he excluded logging trucks or jet aircraft as the source. Two years later, in August 1974, the sounds were reported again.

In May 1976, Vogel noted that several loggers in an area four or five miles west of Satus Pass on U.S. 97 heard what sounded like "several large turbines start up and run." The loggers compared the sounds, which seemed to come from beneath them, to the turbines in the powerhouse at Grand Coulee Dam.

Vogel also noted that a former gate guard at the Mill Creek Guard Station, a few miles west of Satus Peak, had heard underground "turbines" in the evenings when out in the yard of the station.

By November 1976 Vogel reported that the sounds had been heard "all the way from Fort Simcoe (7 1/2 miles north-northwest of Satus Peak) to almost the entire length of Toppenish Ridge." In September 1978 the sound of underground turbines or engines was heard at Sopelia Tower at the southern boundary of the reservation for seven hours (approximately 9:00 p.m. to 4:00 a.m., September 3-4). According to Vogel the noise was like a "turbine" or "unsynchronized propellers on multi-engine aircraft." When let outside the lookout station, the fire lookout's dog displayed anxiety, and the lookout felt barely perceptible vibrations under her feet when standing on a concrete slab. The lookout said she had heard the same sound during the summer of 1978, but always during daylight.

During my investigations, I persuaded the fire lookouts to comb through their logbooks and diaries for all references to UFOs, unexplained phenomena and sounds. Here are their references to sounds:

(1) Satus Peak, 7:30 p.m., August 28, 1974. "Heard rumbling noises again. No wind at time."

(2) Satus Peak, 5:30 p.m., October 14, 1974. "Can hear loud rumblings," the lookout wrote. The lookout received a call from the lookout at Sopelia Tower: "She heard rumblings, too (at Sopelia)."

(3) Satus Peak, 1:30 a.m., May 28, 1979. "Heard the strangest noise. Went on catwalk and listened. Sounded like big drops of water hitting a paper, or two sticks hitting together. Loud. Noise sounded like it was bouncing around different places. Real spooky. I even

looked in the sky for something.”

(4) Satus Peak, 6:30 p.m., October 11, 1979. “Out on north side of catwalk. Heard a loud humming noise. Could not see anything. Eerie sounding.”

(5) Satus Peak, approximately 9:30 a.m., October 22, 1979. Something “emitting a high-pitched whine passed directly over the top of the lookout. Whatever it was, it passed quite closely.” The two lookouts, together in the station, stated that the sound wasn’t a jet’s; it was not ear-splitting, but loud enough to be discernible.

(6) Satus Peak, 1:35 p.m., August 18, 1980. “Heard that motor sound again, like underground. First time this year.”

(7) Satus Peak, 9:37 a.m., July 16, 1982. “Heard a rumble.”

(8) Satus Peak, 9:40 a.m., July 18, 1982. “Heard a big truck pull up beside the lookout and shut its motor off. I jumped up and peeked out the window, expecting to see a big cattle truck with racks, but there was nothing out there!”

(9) Satus Peak, approximately 6:30 a.m., September 1983. “I was checking the rain gage, and I heard soft music for a bit. *I really did* and looked all around wondering if a car was parked some place with a radio on but couldn’t see a thing.” (Rain gage is 40 feet from lookout station.)

(10) Satus Peak, 9:40 a.m., July 18, 1984. “I heard my ‘truck noise.’” The lookout thought she heard a vehicle coming up the road to the top of the peak. When she checked, she saw nothing. She had heard the “truck noise” several times before.

England

Harold T. Wilkins, a British UFO writer from the early 1950s, reported “unexplained noises which seem to come from underground” in *Flying Saucers Uncensored* (1955) and in *Flying Saucers on the Attack* (1954). The sounds were heard at Chalfont St. Giles, Buckinghamshire (close to the Chiltern Hills); Leigh-on-Sea, Essex; north Lincolnshire; southwest London; and Surrey. In Surrey the sounds were heard in deep-lying chalk caves; they were also heard at the bottom of a Yorkshire coal mine.

Wilkins quotes from a correspondent’s letter regarding the Chalfont sounds: “These noises were first heard in September, 1953. They became very audible around Christmas, 1953. The sound was described as a persistent humming of deep vibration and regular pulsation. On occasions it kept people awake at night, when the sounds intensified to a noise like a plane ‘revving’ up its engines, or a motor truck climbing a hill.” (Recall that the Satus Peak lookout compared the sounds she heard to a truck laboring up an incline.)

Wilkins quotes from the correspondent’s description of the sounds given to him by a neighbor, Mrs. Craig: “The mysterious sound is not high-pitched. Mrs. Craig

describes it as resembling the sound of ‘giant wheels turning.’ Sometimes it seems to go up and down the walls of her rooms. But the actual direction of the sound varies and seems to be unaffected by wind direction.”

The correspondent goes into some detail concerning his own experiences with the sounds:

“It sounds to me like a *very heavy machine* working a long way off, and it has a regular pulse of vibration, which suggests either that the machine passes through a regular phase of vibration, or else there is a regular periodic build-up of sound waves. The unchanging pitch indicates that the machine always runs the same speed. I know of no normal machine which could do this, day and night for months....

“One cannot tell the direction of the sound. It is simply there. One may lose it by moving a short distance from one point where it is audible. So back to that point, and the sound is still there.... It seems completely elusive. One can go away from it, but not apparently approach it beyond a certain limit. Either it must be very deep below the surface, or else — a wild surmise — it might be located in a fourth dimension!”

Another correspondent, this one from Essex, had a similar report. A phenomenon similar to the Chalfont sound had been heard at Leigh-on-Sea:

“For the past twelve months, 1953-54, my wife and I have been hearing a strange noise, intermittent, but continuing for fairly long periods. It is a combination of buzzing and grating sounds. The description of rumbling trucks, such as you mention about the Chalfont St. Giles sounds, would fit very well. Strangely enough, the noise is not apparent earlier than about 11-11:30 p.m. On occasions it is extremely loud.”

The correspondent stated that when he went outside to hear the noise more clearly, he heard nothing at all.

Wilkins and his correspondent discounted telephone wires, water pipes, aircraft, construction, local factories, appliances or rail activity as sources of the sounds.

The first correspondent related a sighting of a UFO four miles from Chalfont St. Giles in spring 1954. While walking home at night, he sighted a “brilliant light” with an estimated diameter of 20 feet. It was hovering at an altitude of approximately 500 feet.

“The intensity of the light it projected was like that from an electric welding-arc. It hurt my eyes to look at it. About thirty seconds passed. Then the light seemed to give a convulsive jerk. A kind of bulge or blister sprang out of the left side. I could see that the thing was a globe. The blister was not as bright as the main body. A moment later the light vanished.”

He also reported seeing in summer 1953 “a steady orange light moving north over the sky of Herts, *against* [his italics] a westerly breeze.”

Italy

Here, from the *Toronto Globe-Mail* (February 7,

1979), is a description similar to those made by persons who heard the Yakima and Chalfont sounds:

ROME—Heavy-eyed from lack of sleep, thousand of Romans are trying to locate the source of a mysterious rumbling noise that has kept inhabitants of several areas of the city awake each night for about a week.

Police, the City Council and newspapers have been inundated with telephone calls complaining about the noise which has been variously described as the sound of a subterranean machine, a motorcycle or the purr of some gigantic cat.

The noise is heard between 2 and 6 a.m. in totally unrelated areas in the center and suburbs, and harassed but skeptical policemen have been unable to trace any source of "il ron-ron."

The newspaper *Il Messagger di Roma* has offered a prize to the first person who succeeds in identifying the nuisance.

Colorado

In 1967 Tom Adams of Paris, Texas, became interested in the famous case of an Appaloosa mare, Snippy. Snippy's owners asserted that the horse had died under strange circumstances and had been mutilated by extraterrestrials.

In March and June 1970, Adams and two companions, Stan Ferguson and Gary Massey, traveled to the San Luis Valley near Alamosa, Colorado, to investigate the Snippy case for themselves. Adams recalled:

During our initial trip to the San Luis Valley in 1970, my colleagues and I were told of mysterious *motorlike sounds* that seemed to emanate from a portion of the Blanca Massif — the group of mountains containing Mount Blanca itself and a number of other high peaks located east of Alamosa. These mountains form a portion of the eastern boundary of the San Luis Valley and lie south of the Great Sand Dunes. The mountains from which the sounds originate overlook the site of the death of Snippy the horse, and the sounds had been reported from at least that time — I've not yet traced them back to try to establish the earliest reports. During the period in which the sounds have been heard (late '60s until mid-'70s), UFO and paranormal phenomena have been reported in the valley, plus livestock mutilations, with the latter peaking in the mid-'70s.

Camping on the western slope of the Sangre de Cristos, northwest of Mount Blanca and south of the Sand Dunes, we heard the sounds in 1970. Two or three nights in succession, it "cranked up" after midnight and subsided shortly before dawn. It wasn't really loud enough to hear over conversation — but definitely sounded like a *motor* of some sort, with a suggestion of a *dynamo-type whine* to it. And others had said that it sometimes seems even louder with an ear to the ground. One could easily *imagine* [Adams' emphasis] the sound coming from beneath the surface, but whether it did or not remains purely speculative.

Adams states he heard the sound from time to time on subsequent trips to the area. He last heard the sound in March 1976 while hiking alone. "As always, one could never judge precisely where the sounds were coming from — just somewhere along the range," he said.

Stan Ferguson added this information concerning UFOs in the area:

We were camped out near an old pioneer cemetery, Uracca Cemetery. Several people had reported round orbs of light hovering over the cemetery which was rather isolated.... There is a road, the Sand

Dunes Road, that was parallel to us where we were camped out. One night we saw a round light appear just as if someone turned on a light switch. From the first light a second light appeared, then a third and a fourth. There was a bluish-white light, smaller than the others, which buzzed around the other lights. The sighting lasted for approximately 15 minutes. When we first spotted the light over the Dunes Road, Gary Massey got in the car and drove down the mountainside to get a closer look. By the time he got down to the road, the lights had merged back into one light and then disappeared. This sighting occurred at the same time that we were hearing the "motor sounds."

Texas

Five hundred miles to the southeast, in Robertson County in central Texas, a UFO flap broke out in June 1972 and peaked in November/December 1973. Most of the UFO sightings were centered over Calvert, a small ranching community of 2000. Timothy Green Beckley reviewed the events occurring there in "Calvert, Texas: Flying Saucer Way Station" in the magazine *UFO Report*.

Gracia Unger, editor of the *Calvert Tribune*, and ufologist Tommy Roy Blann investigated the Robertson County occurrences. Beckley noted that Calvert is in the midst of several important space and military installations. These include underground missile silos and Army and Air Force bases (Fort Hood is 15 miles away). Beckley wrote:

Indeed, if UFOs are using this particular area as a base or way station — as now seems to be obvious — where are they hiding? Tommy Blann says he personally knows of caverns which exist beneath farmland on the outskirts of town. "There is a complex network of caves and tunnels which connect somewhere underground. A check of geographical survey maps will show that Calvert is *built directly on top of a fault line* which zigzags for miles in all directions."

Blann told me that ranchers and farmers in the area have reported hearing *peculiar noises coming from deep beneath their feet*. "Individuals living five or six miles outside Calvert have told me how they have repeatedly been driven out of their homes into the cool evening air by the *sound of generators*. It appears to them as if a *steady droning noise is originating from all directions but is loudest when ears are placed to the ground*. This bit of information has led me to conclude that UFOs operating around here have established bases for themselves far beneath the Earth's crust."

The similarity in detail between the Calvert sounds and those in Colorado and at Yakima is striking. In 1983 Blann provided me more information:

Most of the "generator hums" were noted around 7:30 p.m., 11:30 p.m., and 2:00 a.m. and would last for about one-and-a-half to two hours at the maximum. The noises were such that they could not be traced to one particular location; it was almost as if the sounds were mobile and changed locations in the area at night. Mysterious light flashes at night were noted in some of these areas where the sounds were coming from. A flash would come up from the ground and spread out in a V shape in a split second. The light would be a reddish-yellow sometimes to a silvery white.

Dead animals such as birds, squirrels, etc., were found in some of these areas where the light flashes had been seen. It appeared some of the birds fell out of the trees dead. There were no signs of heat, such as singeing or charring.

The sounds could be very distinctly heard on cold, clear, crisp nights. The sounds were very [Blann's emphasis] resonating in the atmosphere and on objects such as houses, trees, ground. You could almost feel your organs vibrating inside your body. I cannot begin to describe how it really felt and the unusual feelings afterward, i.e., tingling, loss of equilibrium, nausea.

Among the phenomena being reported in Calvert were radio interference with amateur radio broadcasts, blackouts of street arc lights, animal reactions before and during UFO appearances, multicolored nocturnal lights, objects with elongated or extended forms with domes or features suggesting "craft" and a seven-foot-tall hairy creature.

Puerto Rico

In 1973 Spanish UFO investigator Salvador Freixedo reported in *Flying Saucer Review* on UFO sightings that occurred in Santo Domingo and Puerto Rico during August, September and October 1972. In early December 1972, Freixedo gave a talk on UFOs in the garden of a friend's house before 40 people. Freixedo claimed that during his talk, an accountant saw a blinking, pink-colored light hovering above the house. After a while, it vanished.

A few days later, Freixedo was visited by an engineer who had tape-recorded Freixedo's talk. The engineer played the tape. "...[A] very strange and very loud sound, like the noise of some machine working in the close vicinity of where I was had appeared on the tape, superimposed over my voice though not blotting it out entirely." Freixedo goes on to say:

The sound...is like the *running of a motor*. Its rhythm is quite a lot faster than the rhythm of the spools of the recorder. At times it blots out my voice entirely, and it changes in volume at several points on the tape. Towards the middle of the talk, and after a *noise like the sound of gears changing*, my voice vanishes altogether, and the sound of the machine becomes a *beep, beep, beep* [Freixedo's italics], very faint, and with a complicated rhythm. Two minutes later my voice reappears, and once more the powerful noise of the machine running is heard.

New Jersey

C. Louis Wiedemann of Vestigia reported in *Fate* on a series of strange incidents that occurred in 1976 in the White Meadows Lake area of northwestern New Jersey. The following is especially pertinent:

Several people reported hearing nighttime sounds resembling "underground construction work" and "*subterranean machinery*." There was also the noise of a *truck ascending a hill in low gear but "never reaching the top."* [Remember Vogel's statement.]

These odd noises, which lasted a full 30 minutes whenever they were heard, always occurred late at night. A housewife heard the *trucklike sounds* one night at 1:00 a.m.; the noise seemed to originate from the direction of high-voltage electric lines which run through the woods. On that same morning, her husband awoke at 3:00 a.m. and heard the same sound, still droning on.

Vestigia received reports of giant, hairy bipeds in rural Morris, Warren, Hunterdon and Sussex counties. Wiedemann and a fellow investigator personally heard eerie howls of unseen animals emanating from the dense forest bordering the suburb of White Lakes Meadow. Also investigated were UFOs, a hovering triangular object, aerial orange and white lights, beeping sounds and brilliant flashes like a flashbulb being fired 100 yards above houses and trees.

Pennsylvania

For over 25 years Stan Gordon and a network of investigators have gathered information on UFOs and other anomalies in southwestern Pennsylvania. Gordon reports:

Over the years, *strange underground sounds* have been reported from various areas of the state. From early 1970s up to the present, there have been numerous cases of orange-red balls of light.... In the late 1960s, I recall [underground sound] reports around New Kensington in Westmoreland County where there had been sounds *like heavy machinery*. There have also been similar sounds reported near Derry and New Alexandria in the early 1970s, several years before the massive Bigfoot flap broke out in the same area. There have been some skyquakelike phenomena in this area where the ground shook and lights were seen at the same time.

California

In 1974 Vogel was contacted by B. Ann Slate, a Los Angeles freelance writer of UFO and Bigfoot articles. Until her death in 1978, Vogel corresponded with Slate providing her material for articles on the Yakima Indian Reservation sightings. In *Bigfoot* (1976) a book Slate coauthored with Alan Berry, a fellow Bigfoot investigator, Slate wondered if Bigfoot lived in natural underground tunnels formed long ago beneath the San Andreas fault. Bigfoot and the creature's tracks had been sighted in the Big Rock Campground in the San Gabriel Mountains. In the campground, investigators attempted to record underground sounds using a tape recorder. Slate reports:

Nothing could be heard but the sound of the crickets chirping. Yet when the tape was replayed, *sounds of machinery* were distinctly heard — those resembling a *generator or hydroelectric plant in operation* but coming from *beneath* [Slate's italics] their feet. The sounds do not remain consistent but subtly change, *as if new "gears" are set in motion*. [Recall Freixedo's tape.] Suddenly the sounds stop. From the tape comes a harsh, almost computer-like voice that whispers something sounding very much like "Keep out! We don't want...." And with that, the voice fades.

Slate reports two other instances of these sounds. In March 1975, she received a letter from a witness in Cedar City, Utah:

My wife and I moved into a mountain cabin 70 miles from Cedar,

high in the mountains. Every night at around 11 o'clock, we hear a *motor running*, but it sounds far away and runs through the night.

The witness wondered if the sound was caused by a mining operation, but because the sound was heard on the weekend when the mining company was shut down, he excluded this possibility.

In the third report, a Canadian man reported that while on a hunting expedition 435 miles north of Montreal, at night he heard a sound that "seemed to come from the bowels of the earth. It sounded like *machinery*, the same sound you would hear if you were in an engineering plant." The nearest town was 235 miles away; the witness ruled out vehicular and waterfall activity.

Pine Bush, New York

Ellen Crystall of New Milford, New Jersey, reports observing and photographing UFOs near Pine Bush, New York, since 1980. She states that she has felt warm air being "vented" from an underground installation where the UFOs land. One night she passed a field where "drilling" was occurring:

...the drilling was so loud that with my windows rolled up and air conditioning on, I almost thought it was the transformer on a pole I was passing. But something "clicked" in my head and I stopped, pulled over, opened my window, and clearly heard something like a pneumatic drill from the dense forest behind the small field....

I am receiving reports from around the country about underground drilling in woods in the middle of the night, and *generators coming apparently from underground* where there isn't anyone doing construction. Many times, including in the Pine Bush area, there appears to be "construction" going on all night long and when you get close, all the lights go out.

Patterns

In all the locations above (except Italy), UFOs were reported during the period the sounds were heard. Specifically, reddish-orange balls of light have been sighted at Yakima and Pennsylvania; orange and white "lights" (the exact shape of the "light" was never stated) have been sighted at Yakima and in England, Colorado, New Jersey and Pennsylvania. "Hairy creatures" have been reported at Yakima, Texas, New Jersey, Pennsylvania and California. Earthquake faulting exists at Yakima, New Jersey, Pennsylvania and California. Italy is a volcanic, earthquake-prone country (as is most of the Mediterranean area).

An explanation?

Are the sounds caused by seismic processes? The Tectonic Strain Theory (TST) of UFOs developed by neurophysiologist Michael Persinger (and interpreted geophysically by John Derr of the U.S. Geological Survey) proposes a scenario to explain UFOs. Perhaps

the TST may point toward a possible explanation for some objects — but certainly not craft or hairy creatures.

In its barest form, the TST accounts for UFO "luminosities" (that is, nocturnal lights) as the result of electromagnetic fields or electrons released from rock during periods of mounting tectonic strain. The energy ionizes gases in the atmosphere, and somehow a ball of light, usually red-orange, is produced. Ultimately, the subterranean tectonic pressure is relieved in an earthquake, and the luminosities vanish. Rather than describe all the complexities of the TST, let us note that the theory predicts the occurrence of luminosities in earthquake-prone, faulted regions.

Geophysicists know that several different types of energy waves are produced by earthquakes — P, S and Rayleigh waves. P waves travel through solid rock, volcanic magma or ocean water, a fraction of them emerging from deep in the earth and entering the atmosphere where animals and humans hear those more than 15 Hertz. Helmut Tributsch believes that perceptible earthquake noises can begin seconds before tremors — and may be detected *without earth movements present*, an interesting fact in that the accounts of underground sounds cited here fulfill this characteristic.

The Yakima fire lookouts, however, did occasionally report feeling earthquakes without accompanying sounds:

(1) Satus Peak, around midnight, June 25, 1981. "I thought I might have felt a tremor, a small earthquake."

(2) Summer 1982. The Satus Peak lookout heard underground sounds and later that summer was "bounced" off her bench in the lookout station. (Interestingly, on February 1, 1981, a magnitude 3.8 earthquake 1/10 km beneath Toppenish Ridge occurred in the vicinity of the Mill Creek Guard Station where underground sounds had been heard in the past.)

(3) Sopelia, 10:51 p.m., September 15, 1983. Lying awake in bed, the fire lookout felt a 15-20 second tremor.

(4) Satus Peak, 9:30 p.m., October 2, 1983. The lookout, in bed, felt "a slight tremor, like an earthquake."

In support of the underground sound/seismicity link, it is curious that Wilkins notes that on December 23, 1953, at 3:38 p.m., "a great explosion was heard all over south and west London." He reported in *Flying Saucers on the Attack* that the mysterious underground sounds were "very noticeable both *before* [my italics], during and after Christmas, 1953" — the period of the inexplicable sonic boom.

This compares favorably with a "sonic boom" heard on February 5, 1989, south and west of Greensburg in Westmoreland County, Pennsylvania, headquarters of Stan Gordon's investigations group.

This wasn't the first time a mysterious "sonic boom" struck Westmoreland County. On September 26, 1965, "booming explosions" rocked the center of the county. Homes were rocked from Uniontown to Irwin; dishes rattled in cupboards. Perhaps most telling was this

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but reliving their own births. Amazingly, some took him seriously.

The first harbinger of change in the wind was the publication, in the summer of 1980, of Charles Berlitz and William L. Moore's *The Roswell Incident*, a book which, its numerous flaws notwithstanding, showed careful readers that there is a crashed-disc case that does not depend on friend-of-a-friend testimony, or even the testimony of a single direct "witness." Even those deeply skeptical of such claims were forced to acknowledge — and did so in greater and greater numbers as Moore and Friedman's post-book (and post-Berlitz) research uncovered more and more informants, all telling stories that matched other participants' accounts — that crashed discs no longer looked like an absurd impossibility. In 1988 CUFOS launched an independent investigation which has uncovered yet more informants (over 160 in all, at current count), clarified significant aspects of the episode, and answered many of the remaining questions. The new investigation would also lay to rest lingering suspicions (for which no evidence had ever surfaced) that the device that crashed or the occupants who died in the incident were of conventional origin. Meanwhile, as the decade closed, startling revelations have come out of Nevada and, interestingly enough, from a mainstream media source — revelations that, if true (and a great deal more investigation will have to be conducted before we know for certain one way or another), tell us something of what happened *after* the Roswell incident. (I do not refer here, I suppose I must add, to certain tales, known to all of us, told by and for idiots. Anyone who tells or believes these tales forfeits any claim to being taken seriously by any of the rest of us.)

To all appearances there *is* a cover-up, and it involves some very interesting things indeed. Perhaps Donald Keyhoe and NICAP were half-right: correct about the official secrecy, wrong about what the big secrets were.

Meanwhile we now know that what for years has been a subject of rumors and paranoia is true: agents of the U.S. government *are* spreading disinformation through the UFO community. No one disputes that anymore, though some of those quick to criticize Bill Moore for what he has observed and reported of that process seem not to understand the significance of these developments, which we now know began not, as an American ufologist recently wrote in a British UFO magazine, with the Bennewitz affair (of 1980-84) but in 1972, with Robert Emenegger, and continues into the present and involves a number of individuals. Such a considerable (and expensive) effort makes no sense, of course, if we hold to the belief that no UFO secrets need to be protected from prying ufologists and journalists.

The importance to ufology of Budd Hopkins'

Missing Time (1981) and *Intruders* (1987) can hardly be overstated. From them, and from the additional research by others they have inspired, we know vastly more about the abduction phenomenon than we did at the beginning of the decade. Thomas E. Bullard's pioneering work has demonstrated, beyond any conceivable refutation, that abductions are a phenomenon, as opposed to assorted fantasies randomly clumped around a general concept of alien kidnapping, and that its patterns are robust over time and space regardless of whether the relevant incidents are consciously or hypnotically recalled or who the investigators are. Meanwhile growing numbers of trained medical, mental-health and other scientific professionals have entered the investigation (i.e., bestirred themselves from the armchair, the traditional sanctuary from which sneers and "explanations" have been hurled) and found themselves as puzzled as the ufologists who went before them. Today no knowledgeable observer denies that abductions constitute an extraordinary phenomenon and a deep enigma.

As all this was going on, ufology became increasingly professionalized. True, instances of incompetence, credulity, stupidity, paranoia, conspiracy-mongering and other human foibles continued to manifest, and will do so as long as anyone can call himself a "ufologist," get quoted in his local newspaper, and have himself presented as a spokesman for all ufology in the pages of *Skeptical Inquirer*. But all across the world the best UFO organizations have worked hard to develop standards and to discourage the sort of wild-eyed enthusiasm that turns every appearance of Venus into a visit from Venusians. Sometimes this has led, in my view, to excesses of quite another kind, to the concoction of "theories" that present themselves as cautious and scientific but that on close examination prove to have little or no empirical foundation. But perhaps this sort of conservative overreaction is an inevitable stage in the evolution of ufological thought, and the most articulate of its spokesmen have made us take a new look at our data and ask if alternative interpretations are possible. If in the end many of their ideas seem to be mistaken, they are still to be commended for raising questions that had to be asked.

The 1980s saw significant new additions to the UFO literature. Besides the titles mentioned above, these include several fine books by our indefatigable British colleague Jenny Randles. Unfortunately her books have been largely unread on this side of the ocean, no doubt because most have not been published here; but one of her best, *Abduction*, has been released in this country as *Alien Abductions: The Mystery Solved* (the publisher's title, not hers) and is available for \$13.95 postpaid from Inner Light Publications, Box 753, New Brunswick, New Jersey 08903. Randles' *The UFO Conspiracy* (1987), Lawrence Fawcett and Barry J. Greenwood's *Clear Intent* (1984) and Timothy Good's *Above Top Secret* (1988) are valuable examinations of what the U.S. and other govern-

ments are or are not doing about UFO reports. Although I have reservations about many of her ideas, and not only about cattle mutilations, Linda Moulton Howe's *An Alien Harvest* (1989) is a valuable account of the author's and others' involvement in various bizarre efforts by military personnel either to tell the "truth" about UFOs or to create a whole new literary genre, science-disinformation. Thomas E.

Bullard's two-volume *UFO Abductions: The Measure of a Mystery* (1987) is the only entirely objective study of the phenomenon, and it is far and away the most scholarly. It is also one of the five finest books ever written on a UFO-related subject. Hilary Evans argues for the psychosocial hypothesis in *Visions, Apparitions, Alien Visitors* (1984) and *Gods, Spirits, Cosmic Guardians* (1987), books that even those who are unconvinced by the author's conclusions will find well worth reading. The same can be said of Paul Devereux's interesting *Earth Lights Revelation* (1989). Richard Hall makes an intelligent case for the extraterrestrial hypothesis in *Uninvited Guests* (1988). Daniel Cohen's largely overlooked *The Great Airship Mystery* (1981) is an essential book on a historical UFO (or pseudo-UFO) episode. Loren Gross has continued his splendid (and privately-published) series on the early history of the UFO mystery; the most recent title is *UFO's: A History — 1953: January-February* (\$6.00 from Loren Gross, 690 Gable Drive, Fremont, California 94538). D. Scott Rogo and Ann Druffel's *The Tujunga Canyon Contacts* (1980), Philip J. Imbrogno's *Night Siege* (1987, written with the assistance of J. Allen Hynek and Bob Pratt), Richard F. Haines' *Melbourne Episode* (1987) and Ed Conroy's *Report on "Communion"* (1989) are in-depth looks at particular cases.

CUFOS personnel also contributed to the decade's serious literature. In 1981 CUFOS published *UFO Reports Involving Vehicle Interference* by Mark Rodeghier, who succeeded Dr. Hynek as CUFOS' scientific director. George M. Eberhart, CUFOS librarian, compiled the two-volume *UFOs and the Extraterrestrial Contact Movement* (1986), likely to remain the UFO bibliography for some time to come. Mimi Hynek edited the CUFOS publication *The Spectrum of UFO Research* (1988), from a 1981 CUFOS conference. Under the able editorship of Michael D. Swords, ufology again has a refereed scientific periodical, *Journal of UFO Studies*; the one issue so far (published in early 1989) contained three of the decade's most important papers, by Bullard (on hypnosis in abduction research), Erol A. Faruk (on laboratory analysis of material from the Delphos, Kansas, CE2) and Swords himself (on ufology, astronomy and extraterrestrial life).

Mention should be made as well of the good efforts of our friends at the Mutual UFO Network, which every year publishes a symposium proceedings which no serious student of our subject can do without. Not every paper is a masterpiece of cogent analysis, by any means,

but the best ones are of lasting worth, as I have found as I have sought reliable sources of information for my own current research project.

In writing what some readers no doubt will see as an uncharacteristically optimistic editorial, I do not mean to imply that the 1980s did not have their dark side, most apparent in the sorts of lunatic ravings I have railed against in earlier columns. But those who claim the 1980s were all gloom and doom, and there are some, simply were not paying attention; ufology has its share of those who long ago stopped reading the literature or devoting concentrated thought to the subject. Too bad. If there ever was a time to read and heed, this is it. And things can only get more interesting. — *Jerome Clark*

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Roswell — continued from page 6

involved with that flight.

On the other hand, nearly every detail in the July 9 article is, we contend, incorrect. It appears that the article is the result of a cover story in the making. It is filled with lies that firsthand testimony has recently exposed. Our investigation has shown that Mac Brazel told the July 9 story under duress while in the company of officers from the 509th Bomb Group, that he lied during the interview, and that those officers knew he was lying. It was the beginning of the cover-up that lasted, almost intact, for 30 years.

As a revealing point, we have also learned from Bill Brazel that his father took an oath that he would not reveal the details of the find. Why would the Army ask Mac Brazel to take an oath of secrecy concerning the ordinary weather balloon he found? We suggest the reason is that whatever he found *was secret and had to remain so*. Thus the need for the cover story he gave on July 9 to the *Daily Record*.

Skeptics may say (and in fact have said) that Mac Brazel, by his own words, invalidates the hypothesis that he found a flying saucer. They point to the July 9 article — which they have not bothered to research — and accuse us of not telling the whole story. Our investigation of the Roswell crash and its aftermath has considered *all* the available evidence, much of which we have unearthed ourselves. We have discovered that the events surrounding the crash are not as described in the July 9 article.

As one of the skeptics says, "I'll let Mac Brazel tell the story in his own words."

"I am sure what I found was not any weather observation balloon," Brazel told reporters on July 9 to end the interview. We think that says it all. ■

report: "...flashes and a red glow were seen in the western sky at the time of the supposed explosions." There were also press reports of "two successive booms, the first louder than the second." These descriptions point to quake activity and earthquake lights.

Interestingly, a stretch of the Allegheny Mountain foothills named Chestnut Ridge runs from West Virginia up through Westmoreland County in Pennsylvania. Since 1972 UFOs and Bigfoot have been reported along this ridge. And along the ridge is a major fault line.

An additional clue that machinelike underground sounds may be part of subterranean seismic activity is Wilkins' report of the sudden, simultaneous stampede of hundreds of sheep from folds and barns in the Chiltern Hills in the Chalfont area on October 25, 1889. The stampede occurred over a region of about 40 square miles. Tributsch cites many examples of animal responses to nonperceptible seismicity.

Curiously, during a night in the week of April 4, 1976, the caretaker of a ranch south of Toppenish Ridge on the Yakima Indian Reservation noticed that the horses seemed nervous. Then late in the night, the horses panicked and stampeded through and over the corral fence and through several other fences in the immediate area. Also, the caretaker's horse ran over a mile before stopping in a corral at an abandoned sheep camp. The other horses were in an advanced state of fright. It is possible they reacted to seismic vibrations imperceptible to humans.

Another possibility to consider is the ability of human beings to "hear" microwaves. In Paul Brodeur's *The Zapping of America* (1977) the work of Allan H. Frey is described. Frey found that humans perceive microwaves at frequencies ranging from 300 to 3,000 megahertz. Depending upon the width of the pulse and its repetition rate, the radio-frequency sounds were experienced as a buzzing, ticking, hissing or knocking. Unfortunately, these perceptions do not appear analogous to the "machine" characteristics of the sounds in this paper. Earthquakes are known, however, to emit electromagnetic radiation.

Research is needed to look for evidence of simultaneity between the machinelike sounds and tremors in the areas cited here.

Comparison to known sounds

If the machinelike underground sounds are seismically caused, chances are the established scientific literature should contain references to them. Such references are to be found in William R. Corliss' *Handbook of Unusual Natural Phenomena* (1977) and *Earthquakes, Tides, Unidentified Sounds and Related Phenomena* (1983).

A variety of sounds do *precede* earthquakes. These are typically described as rattling, rushing or windlike sounds, rumblings, roaring, hissing, thunder or explosions. In some cases, witnesses (from the 19th Century)

have described the sound preceding a quake as "a carriage passing by on a paved road." Corliss also includes references to low, dull boomings or detonations. Classified as "water guns" and "land guns," these sounds are multiple discharges occurring in succession and are associated with seacoasts, mouths of rivers, lakes or inland water areas where, Corliss speculates, subterranean forces are slowly cracking and grinding rocks.

Although these descriptions compare favorably to some sounds at Yakima, Chalfont and Pennsylvania (rumbles and "sonic booms"), it is difficult to tell if they have a connection to the machinelike underground sounds — sounds that did not precede any *perceptible* earthquakes.

I did find in Corliss' books, however, at least two references to machinelike sounds (my italics):

In 1928 at Seskin [Scotland?], the locally known "wind in the mountains" was heard by two observers. They described it as "like the noise of a motor running.... It was persistent, unvarying except in the degree of loudness, and without anything like throbbing. In the afternoon it was like that of the rush of a heavy train through a tunnel near by." The observers classified the sound as a "meteorological phenomenon."

In the Libyan desert in 1909, observers heard a sound that started about 7:30 p.m. and continued at intervals until about 8:00 p.m. "There were two distinct sounds; the one somewhat resembled the sighing of the wind in telegraph wires, and the other was a deep throbbing sound that strongly reminded me of the after reverberation of 'Big Ben'.... It was difficult to determine the direction from which the sound came...." Corliss wonders if the phenomenon was caused by blowing sand, microseismic activity or electrostatic discharges from sand dunes.

Conclusion

I have not verified in detail the quake history and faulting of most of the underground-sound locations given here. To state that tectonic strain creates distinctly craftlike UFOs, Bigfoot creatures and other anomalous manifestations, including abduction reports, is patently silly.

Yet the persistent repeatability and uncanny internal consistency of these underground reports — emanating from widely disparate geographic areas, yet tied to the common thread of faults, and in some cases quakes and their related symptoms (booming noises, for example) — not only indicate that the underground-sound phenomenon is real, but raise the question of why UFOs and other strange phenomena should concentrate either for brief periods or for many years in these earthquake-prone areas. Purely coincidence? Are these sounds seismically caused, or something different? Could there actually be, or have been, underground bases in these areas?

I would like to hear from anyone who has information about underground sounds. Please write me at 14120 S.W. 97th Place, Tigard, Oregon 97224.